# MISKATONIC UNIVERSITY

*Arkham, Massachusetts · Established 1797*

Course Unit Description

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| **Course Unit** | Adult Nursing Practice I | | | **Field of study** | Nursing | | |
| **Degree programme** | Bachelor in Nursing | | | **School** | School of Nursing and Health Sciences | | |
| **Academic Year** | 2026/2027 | **Year of study** | 2 | **Level** | First cycle | **ECTS credits** | 6.0 |
| **Type** | Semestral | **Semester** | 1 | **Code** | MU-NUR-2104 | | |

| **Workload (hours)** | 162 | **Contact hours** | **T** | 26 | **TP** | - | **PL** | 34 | **TC** | - | **S** | - | **E** | - | **OT** | 4 | **O** | - |
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T: Lectures; TP: Lectures and problem-solving; PL: Problem-solving, project or laboratory; TC: Fieldwork; S: Seminar; E: Placement; OT: Tutorial; O: Other

| **Name(s) of lecturer(s)** | Eleanor Whitcombe, Rui Albuquerque |
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## Learning outcomes and competences

At the end of the course unit the learner is expected to be able to:

1. plan and carry out nursing care for adults admitted to medical and surgical wards, from the first contact with the patient to the evaluation of the care given
2. examine a patient in a systematic way, interpret the findings and judge when a finding needs to be reported to the medical team
3. prepare and give medicines correctly, including the calculations involved, and explain to patients what they are receiving and why
4. work in a way that protects patients and colleagues from infection, falls, identification errors and other avoidable harm
5. notice when a patient's condition is getting worse and report it to the responsible team in a clear and structured way
6. keep clear and accurate records and hand over care to colleagues at the end of a shift

## Prerequisites

Before the course unit the learner is expected to be able to:

1. describe human anatomy and physiology at an introductory level
2. explain basic pharmacological concepts, i.e., drug classes, pharmacokinetics and pharmacodynamics
3. perform basic life support

## Course contents

This unit introduces students to the everyday work of a nurse on an adult ward. It starts from the nursing process and the assessment of the patient, and then moves to the preparation and administration of medicines and to the practices that keep patients safe in hospital. A large part of the unit takes place in the simulation laboratory, where students practise procedures and work through realistic clinical scenarios before their first clinical placement.

## Course contents (extended version)

1. Caring for the adult patient
   - the nursing process, from assessment to evaluation
   - involving patients and families in decisions about their care
   - writing care plans for common medical and surgical conditions
2. Assessing the adult patient
   - taking a health history
   - vital signs and pulse oximetry
   - assessing pain
   - recognising patients at risk of pressure injury, falls or malnutrition
3. Medicines in nursing practice
   - how drugs act in the body: notions relevant to the nurse
   - dosage and infusion rate calculations
   - oral, topical and parenteral routes
   - checks before administration and double checking with a colleague
   - adverse reactions and medicines that require extra care
4. Safe care in hospital
   - hand hygiene and standard precautions
   - aseptic technique
   - patient identification

   - moving and handling patients
   - reporting incidents and learning from them
5. The deteriorating patient
   - early warning scores
   - when and how to call for help
   - structured communication with the SBAR method
6. Records and handover
   - what goes into the patient record and why
   - legal and ethical aspects of nursing records
   - handing over care between shifts and services
7. Simulation laboratory
   - practice of procedures on task trainers
   - clinical scenarios followed by debriefing

## Recommended reading

1. Fundamentals of Nursing. Patricia A. Potter, Anne Griffin Perry, Patricia A. Stockert and Amy M. Hall, Elsevier, latest edition.
2. Kozier & Erb's Fundamentals of Nursing. Audrey Berman, Shirlee J. Snyder and Geralyn Frandsen, Pearson, latest edition.
3. Physical Examination and Health Assessment. Carolyn Jarvis, Elsevier, latest edition.
4. Patient Safety Curriculum Guide: Multi-professional Edition. World Health Organization, 2011.
5. Medication Without Harm: WHO Global Patient Safety Challenge. World Health Organization, 2017.

## Teaching and learning methods

Lectures (T) present the concepts and the clinical reasoning behind them, using case examples. Laboratory sessions (PL) take place in the simulation centre in groups of at most 12 students: students practise assessment and medication procedures on task trainers and then in clinical scenarios, each followed by a structured debriefing. Tutorials (OT) cover dosage calculation and individual feedback on laboratory performance.

Students must pass the dosage calculation test before they administer medication in the simulation scenarios.

## Assessment methods

1. Alternative 1 (Regular, Student Worker) (Final, Supplementary)
   - Dosage calculation test - mandatory, pass/fail (all answers must be correct)
   - Objective Structured Clinical Examination (OSCE) - 40%
   - Final Written Exam - 60% (the minimum grade of 8 out of 20 points is required)
2. Alternative 2 (Regular, Student Worker) (Special)
   - Dosage calculation test - mandatory, pass/fail (all answers must be correct)
   - Objective Structured Clinical Examination (OSCE) - 40%
   - Final Written Exam - 60%

## Language of instruction

1. English

## Electronic validation

| Course coordinator | Programme director | Head of School | Pro-Rector for Teaching |
|---|---|---|---|
| Eleanor Whitcombe | Daniel Okafor | Margaret Sayles | Henrik Aaltonen |
| 05-10-2026 | 08-10-2026 | 12-10-2026 | 15-10-2026 |